

Developing Your Career Transition Story

Use this page to collect ideas to answer introductory questions (*i.e. Tell me about yourself OR Walk me through your resume*). Do not worry about organizing your content yet; just consider things you might want to include in your answers.

1. Summarize your key selling points – the most important things you want the interviewer to know. Choose items that add the most value to the position for which you're interviewing.

Most important skills or characteristics

Where did you demonstrate this skill?

How did you develop an interest in this industry / function?

(Identify or set the stage of stories you want to tell later.)

2. Articulate elements of your candidacy that differentiate you or provide a competitive advantage.

Key attributes that differentiate you from other candidates

- a.

- b.

- c.

- d.

3. What negative impressions or stereotypes might you have to overcome?

Impression to overcome

Message to address it

4. What is the best way for you to structure your answers – a chronological evolution of interest or by identification of key selling points? (Make any notes in this space.)

Option 1: Telling a story that chronicles the evolution of your career interests.

Once you have some ideas recorded on page 1 concerning what you might include, use this worksheet to help you organize your answers to introductory questions.

First, put the remarks you want to make in the order you want to make them. Frequently this is a simple chronology beginning with your early work experience, though it may begin at a different point in time.

<i>Jobs or experience</i>	<i>Key thing(s) you learned (one of your key skills/selling points, a differentiating characteristic, or a message to overcome a weakness)</i>	<i>How did the experience add to your interest in this career?</i>
1. _____ _____	_____ _____	_____ _____

Transition between 1 & 2 _____

2. _____ _____	_____ _____	_____ _____
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Transition between 2 & 3 _____

3. _____ _____	_____ _____	_____ _____
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Transition between 3 & 4 _____

4. _____ _____

Option 2: Organize your answers to introductory questions according to key skills or selling points.

Once you have some ideas about what you might include, use this worksheet to help you organize your answers to introductory questions.

First, identify the key selling points. Make connections between each selling point and your prior experience.

***Key skill or selling point,
differentiating characteristics, or
message to overcome a weakness***

***How you exhibited and developed
this in prior positions or experiences***

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